

Use Case Manual Age Verification



European
Commission



EU Digital Identity
Wallet

A Use Case Manual is a description of a specific use case for the EU Digital Identity Wallet. It includes an introduction to the use case and the user journey, the state of play of the use case development, as well as references to the relevant technical specifications and infrastructures, legislation, and governance structures.

The Use Case Manual is designed for the Wallet implementers, Member States and other stakeholders interested in the development of the Wallet and its use cases.

The Use Case Manual is not intended to contain full detailed technical specifications for the use case. However, where such specifications are available, the Use Case Manual contains pointers to them.

Description

The **Age Verification** use case allows citizens to prove they are above a specific age threshold (e.g., over 16, 18, or 21) using a verifiable digital credential stored in their EUDI Wallet. The wallet enables confirming age without revealing other personal details such as the full birthdate or name.

Age Verification is performed according to a very strict privacy approach, by presenting an attestation that contains a boolean age claim (e.g., `age_over_18 = true`). The claim can be included in a dedicated attestation or be part of a broader set of attributes in another attestation, such as a mobile driving licence or a photo ID. The use of selected disclosure allows the verifier service to perform an age check without learning the date of birth or other personal details.

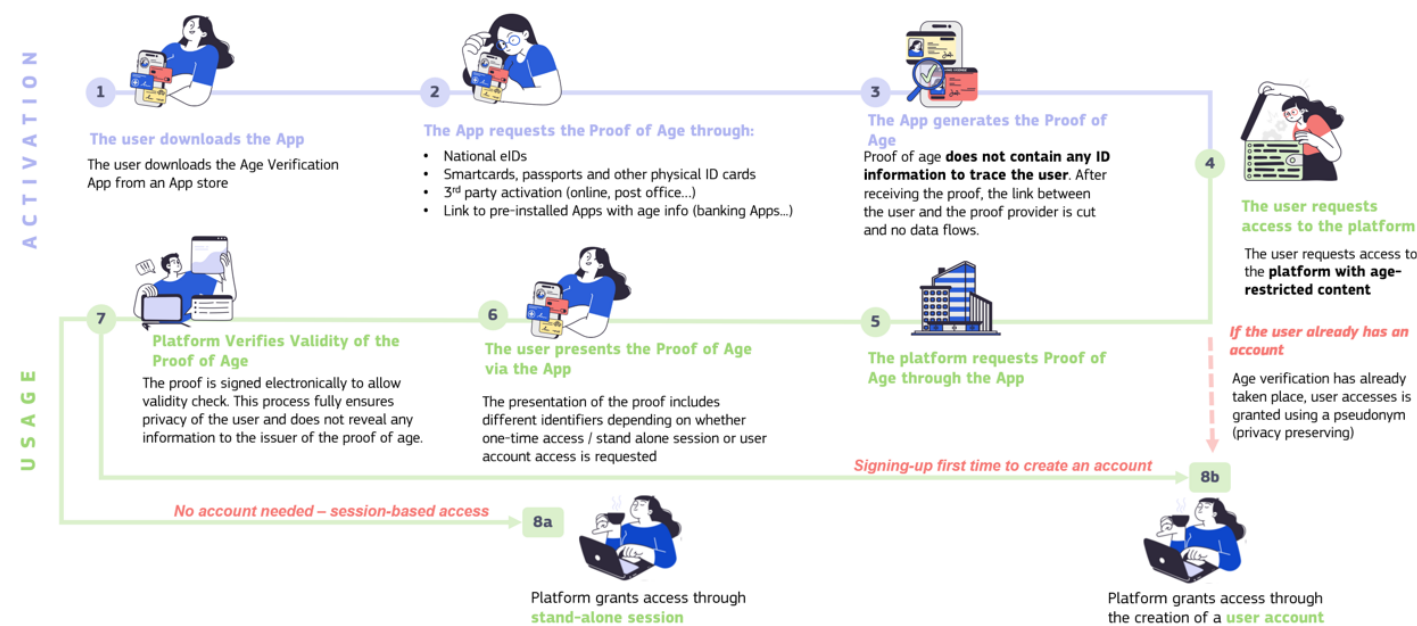
The use case is applicable to both online and proximity scenarios. Examples of scenarios where age verification may be required include:

- Purchasing age-restricted goods (e.g., alcohol, tobacco)
- Accessing online content or services (e.g., adult content, gaming platforms)
- Entering venues (e.g., nightclubs, festivals)
- Using age-gated public services (e.g., youth discounts, senior benefits)

User Journey(s)

1. The user acquires an attestation with a proof of age (a proof of age attestation). The attestation is issued by a trusted authority (e.g., national population registry) and stored by the EUDI Wallet.
2. User seeks to access an age-restricted service (e.g., accessing a website with sensitive content, entering a bar, buying alcohol online).
3. The Relying Party (e.g., website, bartender, vending machine, or online merchant) requests age verification through a standard EUDI Wallet interface.
4. The EUDI Wallet invites the user to prove their age, by showing:
 - The name and identity of the requesting party
 - The requested age threshold (e.g., "18+")
 - A prompt to confirm sharing the proof
5. If the user confirms sharing the proof, the wallet uses the proof of age attestation to generate a cryptographic proof that the user meets the age requirement.
6. The proof is shared with the relying party, who verifies it instantly without seeing any excess personal information.
7. Access is granted or denied based on the result.

Age Verification short-term solution: User Journey (e.g. 18+)



Value for relying parties

Service providers in regulated sectors (e.g., e-commerce, online gaming, content platforms) can **meet legal obligations** for age gating without storing excessive personal data. Receiving only a verified “over age” claim reduces compliance costs, decreases impact of data breaches, and improves onboarding speed.

Value for public authorities

Implementing age verification through the EUDI Wallet allows public authorities to **deliver on their digitalisation and privacy-by-design commitments** to citizens. By embedding privacy-preserving age checks into national wallet systems, authorities can promote safer online environments while giving citizens control over their personal data.

Verifiable age proofs help authorities ensure **compliance with age-related regulations**, reducing reliance on less secure self-declaration methods. By providing regulated industries with a consistent verification mechanism, authorities also improve enforcement efficiency while minimising the risk of data breaches and misuse.

Economic value and potential market size

Issuers: The cost impact is low relative to other wallet functions since age proofs can be derived from other wallet-based identity data such as PID. The value lies in improved **compliance services** that governments can offer to regulated industries (e.g., gambling, adult content, alcohol sales) without privacy compromise.

Relying Parties: As the solution is based on **harmonised EU-level specifications**, relying parties avoid the need to implement support for different national solutions in their services, decreasing costs.

Users: Potential positive impact on the service costs, as costs of implementing age verification are smaller for service providers using an EU-harmonised approach.

Transactions

Volume estimates:

- Gambling sector: ~23 million regular online players in the EU.
- Adult content sites: monthly traffic counts in hundreds of millions; France’s new law implies millions of monthly age checks.

Moving these checks into the wallet reduces per-transaction verification costs from several euros (manual KYC) to cents (automated credential proof).

Synergies with other use cases

As a proof of age attestation may be presented alongside other attestations, further benefits from the use of the wallet for Age Verification can be achieved through synergy with use cases such as:

- PID identification
- Mobile driving licence
- Online payment authorisation

Use case impact

Benefits

End-user/citizen value

Age verification via the EUDI Wallet gives citizens a **privacy-preserving way** to prove they meet a legal age requirement without disclosing unnecessary personal information, such as their exact date of birth or other identity details.

- Convenience:**
No need to upload ID documents to service providers websites.
- Cross-border usability:**
The same age credential works in all participating EU Member States, both online and in person.
- Privacy protection and increased trust:**
Shares only a boolean attribute (e.g., age_over_18), not full date of birth, in line with the GDPR’s data minimisation principle. Individuals explicitly approve each request for age verification, maintaining full control over who accesses this information. Reduces the risk of profiling or misuse of personal information, increasing confidence in online services.

Use case implementation

Existing implementations

On 14 July 2025, the Commission released the first version of the technical specifications and their open-source implementation, forming an [EU age-verification blueprint](#). Testing and piloting is ongoing in collaboration with Member States, online platforms and end-users. Denmark, France, Greece, Italy and Spain are the forerunning countries and will be the first to take it up in their national digital wallets or publish a customised national age verification app based on the same specifications. Market players can also take up the software solution and further develop it.

The full set of technical specifications and their open-source implementation are available [here](#).

Legislation

Article 28 of the Digital Services Act (DSA) requires providers to put in place appropriate and proportionate measures to ensure a high level of privacy, safety, and security of minors, on their service. [Guidelines](#) adopted pursuant to Article 28 further specify cases in which age verification should be used. Examples of these include the sale of alcohol or tobacco, access to pornographic or gambling content, or cases in which a minimum age is prescribed by law.

Technical specifications, software libraries and infrastructure

The full set of technical specifications and their open-source implementation are available [here](#). Development of further features is underway.

Data model, format and proof mechanisms

Detailed [technical specifications](#) of the EU Age Verification solution provide complete information and examples of the attestation and proof mechanisms.

The data model for the proof of age attestation is based on the attribute schema specified in ISO/IEC 18013-5 (Mobile Driving Licence Application) and ISO/IEC 23220-2 (Data objects and encoding rules for generic eID systems).

The attestation format used is ISO mDoc.

Issuance

Proof of age attestations may be issued by entities placed on the trusted list of proof of age attestation providers deployed and managed by the Commission.

OpenID4VCI (OpenID for Verifiable Credential Issuance) may be used for delivering the proof of age attestation to the wallet, however issuers may choose to rely on alternative protocols. Implementation that relies on OpenID4VCI is included in available open-source implementation of the EU age verification solution.

Verification

Presentation via OpenID4VP (available) or via W3C Digital Credentials API (under development). Support for a zero-knowledge proof is upcoming.

Verifiers must check that the attestation issuer is on the trusted list of authorised issuers, maintained by the Commission.

Trust framework

Proof of age attestation issuers are placed on a trusted list maintained by the Commission. Member States notify the European Commission of their accredited issuers, which are then placed on the publicly available list to enable cross-border verification.

Relying party registration is not currently required, awaiting the implementation of the necessary registration procedures.

